Toy Conference on Quantum & Soft Matter 2026

Programme · All times local · Time zone: Europe/Berlin

Monday, 12 October 2026

08:30–09:00	Registration & coffee		
09:00–10:00	**Main Hall**	**Plenary Session: Opening Keynote**	**Chair: M. Curie**
09:00–10:00		Why every photo needs a timestamp	Ada Lovelace (Analytical Engines Ltd.)
10:00–10:30	Coffee break		
10:30–12:00	**Room A**	**Session A1: Quantum Materials**	**Chair: N. Bohr**
10:30–11:00		Topological magnons in thin films	K. Leutner, A. Kumar
11:00–11:30		Moiré excitons at room temperature	L. Meitner
11:30–12:00		Spin qubits in silicon: a reality check	R. Feynman, J. Wheeler
10:30–12:00	**Room B**	**Session B1: Soft Matter & Polymers**	**Chair: P.-G. de Gennes**
10:30–11:00		Self-assembly of block copolymers	D. Hodgkin
11:00–11:30		Active nematics in confinement	S. Edwards
11:30–12:00		Hydrogels that remember	R. Franklin
12:00–13:00	Lunch		
13:00–14:30	**Room A**	**Session A2: Machine Learning for Materials**	**Chair: A. Turing**
13:00–13:30		Foundation models for crystal structures	G. Hopper
13:30–14:00		Vision-language models read your lab notebook	C. Shannon
14:00–14:30		Lit-RAG: retrieval over conference books	J. von Neumann
13:00–14:30	**Room B**	**Session B2: Biophysics**	**Chair: E. Schrödinger**
13:00–13:45		Protein folding under force	F. Crick
13:45–14:30		Membranes as two-dimensional fluids	W. Helfrich
13:00–14:30	**Room C**	**Session C1: Instrumentation**	**Chair: E. Abbe**
13:00–13:45		Cryo-EM on a budget	J. Dubochet
13:45–14:30		Open-hardware AFM	G. Binnig

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09:00–10:30	**Room A**	**Session A3: Superconductivity**	**Chair: H. Kamerlingh Onnes**
09:00–09:45		Nickelates: the next cuprates?	J. Bardeen
09:45–10:30		Hydrides under pressure	V. Ginzburg
09:00–10:30	**Room B**	**Session B3: Glasses & Jamming**	**Chair: G. Parisi**
09:00–09:45		The glass transition in 30 minutes	P. Anderson
09:45–10:30		Jamming of frictional grains	S. Nagel
10:30–11:00	Coffee break		
11:00–12:00	**Main Hall**	**Plenary Session: Closing Keynote**	**Chair: M. Curie**
11:00–12:00		From pictures to knowledge	Grace Hopper